Altitude Angel launches open source hardware and software platform called Scout

Altitude Angel, a provider of UTM (unmanned traffic management) technology, has released an open-sourced project named Scout. It consists of hardware and firmware that will help drone manufacturers, software developers, and commercial drone pilots to quickly connect to its global UTM, the company reports. Altitude Angel does not yet have plans to manufacture the device. It said that it is open to the possibility as part of its work supporting the emerging drone ecosystem.

Scout is primarily intended for use in commercial and industrial drone applications. It comes with the capability to securely obtain and broadcast a form of 'network remote ID'. This is seen as a necessary step for enabling routine drone use and 'beyond visual line of sight' (BVLOS) flight. The hardware and the firmware can be enhanced and incorporated into a virtually limitless set of scenarios due to its open source nature.

Richard Parker, Altitude Angel, CEO and founder said, "For routine automated commercial and industrial use of drones to take flight, several challenges need to be solved. Not least of these challenges is, how will the drone be connected to the digital air traffic control systems of the future? Some proprietary devices exist which provide only a small part of the solution -- getting the drone's location to a single UTM."

He further said, "Scout represents one of the latest projects to emerge from our R&D lab and we're saying to users 'take this device, experiment with it, improve it and integrate it with your solutions, and share your findings with the community'."

The new PyTorch projects announced include TorchServe and TorchElastic. The former is a model-serving framework for PyTorch that makes it easier for developers to move new models into production. TorchElastic is a library that developers can use to build fault-tolerant training jobs on Kubernetes clusters.

PyTorch was created by Facebook's AI research group to function as a machine learning library of functions for the Python programming language. It has been designed for use with deep learning.

Dell launches set of open source networking solutions using SONiC

Dell Technologies has announced a set of open source networking solutions designed to simplify the management of data centres at scale. The solutions, called Enterprise SONiC Distribution, by Dell Technologies are built on Software for Open Networking in the Cloud (SONiC), an open source project headed by Microsoft.

Tom Burns, senior VP and GM, Dell Technologies integrated products and solutions said, "Our customers tell us that, while a hybrid cloud approach is critical to their success, they struggle to maintain and scale their networks, and manage them to effectively avoid multiple points of failure. By breaking switch software into multiple, containerised components, we are providing enterprises the means to drastically simplify the management of massive and complex networks and increase availability in a cloud model."

Dell has said that organisations are increasingly relying on modern hybrid cloud models to do business. This leads to a monolithic and proprietary approach to networking, creating inefficiencies and unneeded complexity. According to Dell, its Enterprise SONiC Distribution removes complexity and creates a flexible network through an approach built on open standards by integrating SONiC into the DNA of the Dell EMC PowerSwitch Open Networking hardware.

Yousef Khalidi, corporate VP of Microsoft Azure Networking, Microsoft Corp., said, "SONiC is a leading open source network switch OS, empowering customers with modern and efficient cloud networking software. We're pleased to see Dell bringing enterprise support to its customers."

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